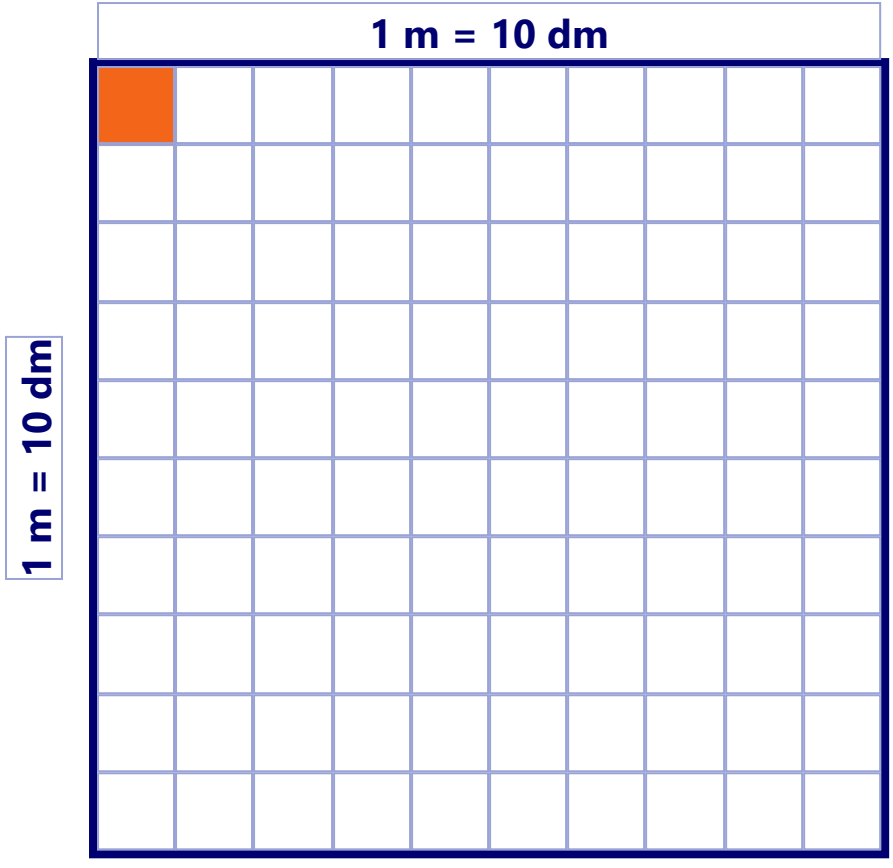
Square units: why the factor is squared



The whole square is **1 m²**.

Each little orange square is **1 dm²**.

There are 10 rows of 10 squares:

10 × 10 = **100 dm²**

Length: 1 m = 10 dm

Area: $1\ m^2 = (10\ dm)^2 =$ **10^2 dm²**